SkillNavora

MODULE 1 HANDBOOK

Module 1: CRM and Digital Marketing Fundamentals

4 sections, 40 topics explained, plus the detailed lessons, examples, exercises and official links.

Salesforce Marketing Cloud (SFMC) Academy. Verify product names, editions, licences and certifications on Salesforce's official pages.

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Edition: November 2026. Practice labs marked "account" need a provisioned Marketing Cloud account. Other labs use sample files or paper.

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Module 1: CRM and Digital Marketing Fundamentals

Level: Beginner. What CRM and digital marketing are, the customer lifecycle, channels and the metrics every campaign is judged on.

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Detailed lessons

Module 1

1.1 CRM and the customer lifecycle

WHAT IS IT?

> A CRM (customer relationship management) system stores customers, their interactions and their history. The lifecycle runs from first awareness to acquisition, onboarding, engagement, retention and re-engagement.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> Marketing automation only works when the customer data and lifecycle stage are right. Most campaign mistakes come from wrong audiences, not wrong emails.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. List the lifecycle stages for your product (for example: visitor, lead, customer, active, lapsed).
2. For each stage, write one message and one goal.
3. Map each stage to the data you need (sign-up date, last purchase, last open).

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> A bank: a visitor who applies for a card moves to lead; approval makes them a customer; no transaction for 90 days starts a re-engagement journey.

COMMON ERRORS

Mixing up lead and customer, so a paying customer gets an acquisition offer.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

Explain the customer lifecycle and one message for each stage.

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Draw the lifecycle for an online course business with five stages and the data field that marks each stage.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- Trailhead (free learning)

Module 1

1.2 Channels and marketing metrics

WHAT IS IT?

> Digital channels include email, SMS, push notifications, web and social media, plus paid advertising. Key metrics: open rate, click-through rate, click-to-open rate, conversion rate, bounce rate, unsubscribe rate and revenue per send.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> Metrics show whether a campaign works and where to fix it. Open rates are affected by Apple Mail privacy features, so click-based metrics are often more reliable.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Calculate open rate as unique opens divided by delivered emails.
2. Calculate click-through rate as unique clicks divided by delivered emails.
3. Calculate click-to-open rate as unique clicks divided by unique opens.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> 1,000 delivered, 250 unique opens, 40 unique clicks: open rate 25%, CTR 4%, CTOR 16%.

COMMON ERRORS

Comparing open rates between campaigns that used different send times or audiences.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

What is the difference between CTR and CTOR?

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Calculate the metrics for three sample campaigns and say which one to repeat and why.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- Salesforce Trailhead: marketing basics

1.1 CRM Fundamentals: every topic explained

What is Customer Relationship Management?. CRM is software and practice for managing every interaction with customers and prospects: who they are, what they bought, and every contact with sales, service and marketing.

CRM architecture. A CRM has a database of accounts, contacts and leads, business objects (opportunities, cases, orders), workflows and reports, usually reached through a web app and APIs.

CRM versus marketing automation. CRM is the system of record for customer relationships; marketing automation sends and tracks campaigns. Marketing tools read CRM data and write engagement back.

Customer lifecycle. The stages a customer moves through: awareness, consideration, purchase, onboarding, active use, loyalty, lapse and win-back. Each stage needs a different message.

Customer data management. Keeping customer data accurate, de-duplicated, consented and up to date, with clear owners and rules for creation and change.

Lead and contact management. A lead is an unqualified prospect; a contact is a known person linked to an account. Leads are qualified and converted into contacts and opportunities.

Customer segmentation. Grouping customers by shared traits (industry, value, behaviour, lifecycle stage) so each group gets relevant messages.

Customer engagement. The level of two-way interaction a customer has with the brand: opens, clicks, visits, purchases, replies and support contact.

Customer retention. Keeping existing customers buying or subscribing. It is usually cheaper than acquiring new customers and is a core marketing goal.

Customer lifetime value. The expected profit from a customer over the whole relationship. Simple form: average order value × purchases per year × years retained × margin.

CRM reporting. Standard CRM reports and dashboards for pipeline, conversion, campaign influence and customer health, used by sales and marketing leaders.

1.2 Digital Marketing Fundamentals: every topic explained

Digital marketing ecosystem. All the online channels a brand uses (email, SMS, push, web, social, search, display, apps) and the tools that connect them.

Email marketing. Permission-based messages sent to a list. It has a strong return because the audience is owned, but depends on consent and deliverability.

SMS marketing. Short text messages to mobile numbers with consent. High open rates; strict rules on opt-in, opt-out, timing and frequency.

Push notifications. Notifications sent to users of a mobile app who allowed them. Used for timely alerts, offers and reminders.

Web marketing. The website and landing pages: content, forms, personalisation and tracking that turn visits into leads and sales.

Social media marketing. Organic posts and community building on social platforms, plus social listening and customer service.

Paid advertising. Paid search, social and display ads bought by impression or click, targeted by audience and keywords.

Marketing automation. Software that sends the right message at the right time automatically based on rules, events and data, such as welcome series and cart reminders.

Omnichannel marketing. A consistent customer experience across channels, where each channel knows the customer's context and history.

1.3 Marketing Strategy: every topic explained

Customer acquisition. Attracting new customers through ads, content, referrals and lead capture, then converting them to first purchase.

Customer onboarding. Helping new customers get value fast with a welcome series, setup steps and first-use help.

Customer engagement. Keeping customers active with useful content, offers and reminders based on their behaviour.

Customer retention. Programmes that reduce churn: loyalty, service follow-ups, renewal reminders and win-back offers.

Re-engagement campaigns. Campaigns for people who stopped opening or buying, with a clear offer and a sunset rule if they still do not respond.

Cross-selling. Offering a related product to an existing customer, such as a phone case after a phone purchase.

Upselling. Offering a higher-value version or upgrade, such as a premium plan.

Customer journey mapping. Drawing each step a customer takes, their goals and the touchpoints, to find where messages help.

Marketing funnels. The stages from awareness to purchase (and beyond), with conversion rates between stages to show where people drop off.

Campaign planning. Defining the goal, audience, message, channels, timing, budget and measures for a campaign before building it.

1.4 Marketing Analytics: every topic explained

Open rate. Unique opens divided by delivered emails. Inflated by privacy features that pre-load images, so use it with care.

Click-through rate. Unique clicks divided by delivered emails: a better signal of real interest.

Click-to-open rate. Unique clicks divided by unique opens: how well the content worked for people who opened.

Conversion rate. Share of recipients who completed the goal (purchase, sign-up) after the message.

Bounce rate. Share of emails that could not be delivered. Hard bounces are permanent; soft bounces are temporary.

Unsubscribe rate. Share of recipients who unsubscribed after a send. A rising rate warns of poor targeting or frequency.

Deliverability. Whether email reaches the inbox (not spam). Depends on authentication, reputation, list quality and content.

Revenue attribution. Giving revenue credit to the messages and channels that influenced a sale (first touch, last touch, multi-touch).

Campaign ROI. Return on investment: (revenue − cost) ÷ cost for the campaign, with stated assumptions.

Customer engagement metrics. Measures such as active rate, frequency of interaction and recency that show how engaged customers are over time.